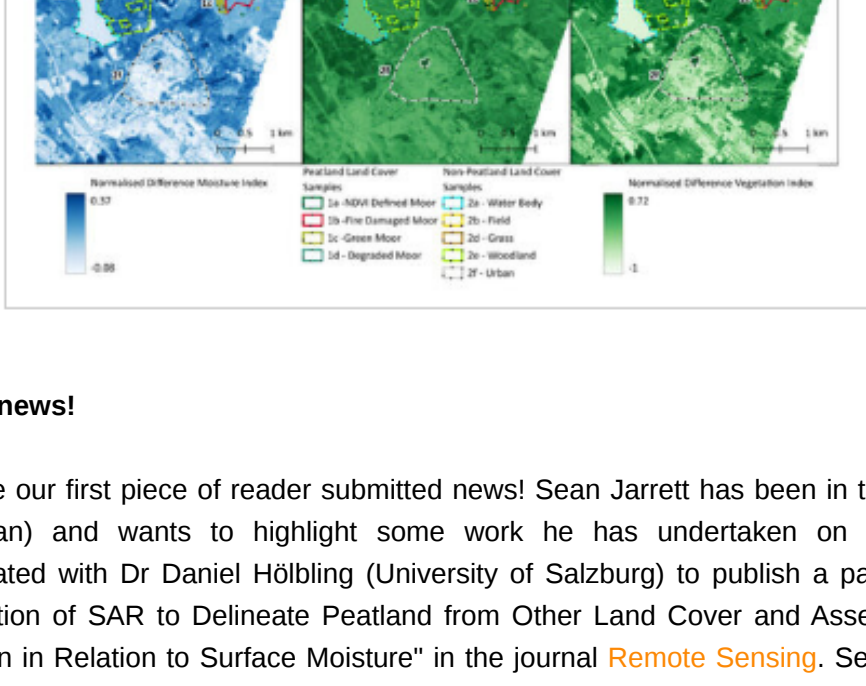




Welcome to the OSGeo:UK Newsletter

Welcome to another OSGeo:UK newsletter where we share updates and information every couple of months about the OSGeo:UK local chapter, along with general FOSS for geospatial goodness. Please share the newsletter widely so that interested friends and colleagues can [sign up](#) too. For now, enjoy this edition.

News from you!



Reader news!

We have our first piece of reader submitted news! Sean Jarrett has been in touch (thank you Sean) and wants to highlight some work he has undertaken on peat. Sean collaborated with Dr Daniel Hölbling (University of Salzburg) to publish a paper entitled "Application of SAR to Delineate Peatland from Other Land Cover and Assess Relative Condition in Relation to Surface Moisture" in the journal [Remote Sensing](#). Sean is a GIS consultant whose work covers GIS applications for nature-based solutions. He has an MSc in Geographical Information Systems and Science from the University of Salzburg alongside an MA in Contemporary European Studies. Sean's research focuses primarily on the use of SAR-based change detection to evaluate natural flood management schemes.

The work described in the paper used QGIS and Sentinel-1 SAR imagery to produce new findings that provide the basis for a methodology in delineating peat from other land cover types. Peat is challenging to map due to difficult terrain and weather conditions. While remote sensing aids mapping, cloud cover often limits effectiveness. Sentinel-1 overcomes this by penetrating clouds. In this study, methods commonly used to detect water surfaces were applied to delineate peatland and assess its condition. The study focused on Winter Hill, near Bolton in the UK, which was the site of a major 2018 wildfire. Sentinel-1 imagery from the following winter accurately reflected fire damage and analysis showed significant statistical differences between frozen peat and visually similar land cover, such as grazed fields. A surface map of peatland and other land covers was produced and validated against field photographs. Results indicated a correlation between backscatter and temperature in peatland surfaces, influenced by slope. Aggregating the satellite data by sub-catchment zones improved differentiation of peatland conditions.

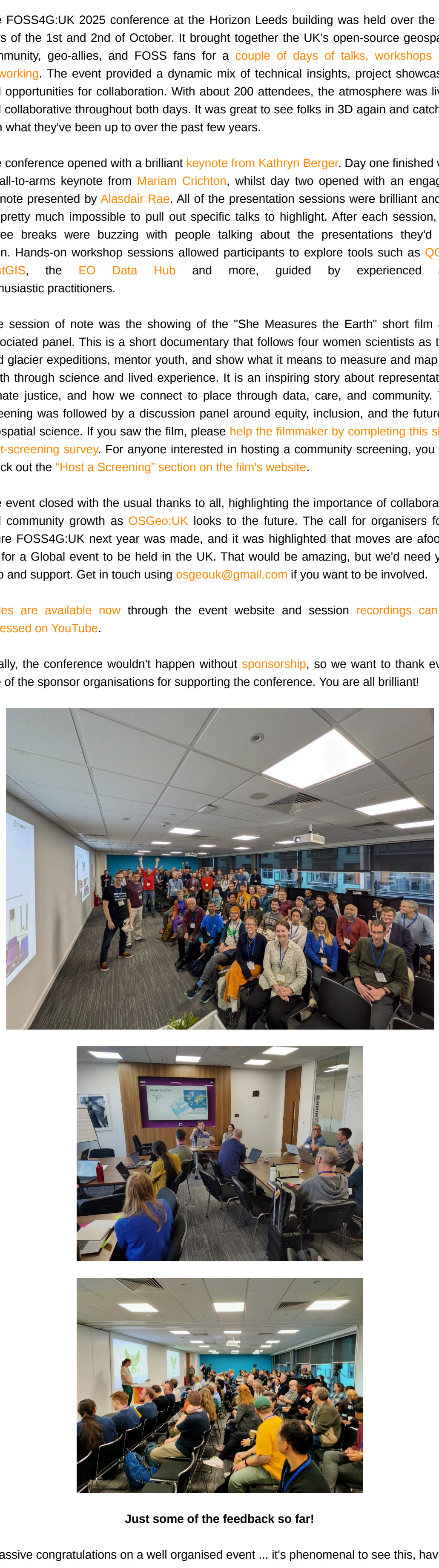
Tell us about your work!

You can [submit news stories](#) to be highlighted in this newsletter by supplying suitable details for us to add to a future newsletter issue.

We are also looking for individuals willing to write a short thought piece, no more than a few hundred words, for inclusion in future newsletters. Use [the same link](#) to submit an idea, which can be about anything to do with the concept of 'open' in geospatial, and we'll get back to you if we'd like you to write that up.

News from OSGeo:UK

Find out more about OSGeo:UK and how you can be part of our community on our [website](#).



FOSS4G:UK 2025

First up, if you attended the FOSS4G:UK conference - thank you, and we hope you enjoyed it. Second up, if you attended the FOSS4G:UK conference, please [complete the feedback form](#). Every piece of feedback helps us put on the future events that you want to attend.

The FOSS4G:UK 2025 conference at the Horizon Leeds building was held over the two days of the 1st and 2nd of October. It brought together the UK's open-source geospatial community, geo-allies, and FOSS fans for a [couple of days of talks, workshops and networking](#). The event provided a dynamic mix of technical insights, project showcases, and opportunities for collaboration. With about 200 attendees, the atmosphere was lively and collaborative throughout both days. It was great to see folks in 3D again and catch up with what they've been up to over the past few years.

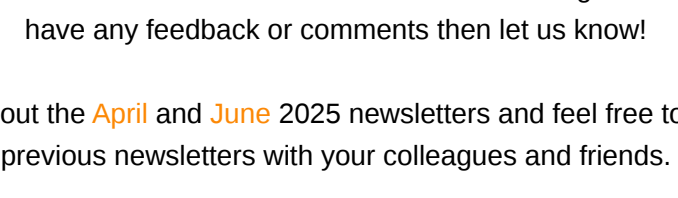
The conference opened with a brilliant [keynote from Kathryn Berger](#). Day one finished with a call-to-arms keynote from [Mariam Crichton](#), whilst day two opened with an engaging keynote presented by [Alasdair Rae](#). All of the presentation sessions were brilliant and so it's pretty much impossible to pull out specific talks to highlight. After each session, the coffee breaks were buzzing with people talking about the presentations they'd just seen. Hands-on workshop sessions allowed participants to explore tools such as [QGIS](#), [PostGIS](#), the [EO Data Hub](#) and more, guided by experienced and enthusiastic practitioners.

One session of note was the showing of the "She Measures the Earth" short film and associated panel. This is a short documentary that follows four women scientists as they lead glacier expeditions, mentor youth, and show what it means to measure and map the Earth through science and lived experience. It is an inspiring story about representation, climate justice, and how we connect to place through data, care, and community. The screening was followed by a discussion panel around equity, inclusion, and the future of geospatial science. If you saw the film, please [help the filmmaker by completing this short post-screening survey](#). For anyone interested in hosting a community screening, you can check out the ["Host a Screening" section on the film's website](#).

The event closed with the usual thanks to all, highlighting the importance of collaboration and community growth as [OSGeo:UK](#) looks to the future. The call for organisers for a future FOSS4G:UK next year was made, and it was highlighted that moves are afoot to bid for a Global event to be held in the UK. That would be amazing, but we'd need your help and support. Get in touch using [osgeouk@gmail.com](#) if you want to be involved.

[Slides are available now](#) through the event website and session [recordings can be accessed on YouTube](#).

Finally, the conference wouldn't happen without [sponsorship](#), so we want to thank every one of the sponsor organisations for supporting the conference. You are all brilliant!



Just some of the feedback so far!

"massive congratulations on a well organised event ... it's phenomenal to see this, having been involved in organising many conferences myself. There is not a lot of room for improvement! ... Truly **one of the best and most enjoyable conferences I've ever attended**"

"it was **beyond my expectations and really enjoyable** - well done to all involved"

"the timing and moderating ... of sessions was unbelievably good, it was noteworthy, **other events can learn from this**"

"credit to all involved - **well organised and well executed, a great event all round**"

OSGeo-related Projects

GoFundGeo

I was going to say that there hasn't been much movement on the GoFundGeo supported projects, because all the attention was around FOSS4G:UK. But I'd be wrong to say that as there continue to be updates and activity on the qgis2web plugin. The project released [version 3.30.0](#) on 11 Oct 2025. This release built up a whole set of functionality around Leaflet and Openlayers, improved handling of web services and integrated a load of changes around Qt6 support.

Whilst Geoserver 3 continues in development, the developers are still pushing updates to the v2 line. The [latest release \(2.28\)](#) is available for installation.

Similarly, development on TerraDraw continues as is evident through the [closed pull requests on the project GitHub page](#).

Remember, it is nearly time for the GoFundGeo grants to be awarded for 2025. Everyone on the [OSGeo:UK committee encourages you to submit bids for a project or projects that you would like to see funded](#) by us through this scheme. Details of how to bid will be released by early November and projects will be able to request a slice of the £6000 total.

Membership levels

€ 27,000+ Flagship Member (e.g. for companies larger than 100 employees, federal governmental organizations)	€ 9,000+ Large Member (e.g. for larger cities, provinces or companies up to 100 employees)	€ 3,000+ Medium Member (e.g. for universities, medium size cities or companies up to 50 employees)	€ 500+ Small Member (e.g. for smaller cities or companies up to 10 employees)
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As this is something that is increasingly something that exercises me, I want to make this call to businesses - above are the sustaining membership levels for QGIS and your organisation can help out. In particular, if you use QGIS in a large corporate entity (especially if the reason for doing so is to save the company money) then please ensure that your Director level staff are aware that they could easily sign off on [becoming sustaining members](#). Very little in this world is totally free, and helping out where possible is a great way to keep the good things in life ticking along. We all win!

Elsewhere in the world of QGIS...

QGIS has updated its [road map towards v4](#) following community discussions regarding a smooth transition to using Qt6.

- **QGIS 4.0 Release:** Now scheduled for **February 2026** (moved from October 2025).
- First LTR (Long-Term Release): QGIS 4.2, planned for October 2026.
- End of 3.x Series: QGIS 3.44 is the final 3.x version and last LTR before QGIS 4.0, providing a stable platform during the transition.

Qt6 builds are already available for testing: on Windows via the OSGeo4W installer, but see the QGIS website for information on Linux and Mac OS. If you are the maintainer of a plugin then we suggest that you check out the testing versions for any compatibility gotchas! Further updates will follow as QGIS approaches the February 2026 release.

Wider geospatial news

The [global FOSS4G](#) event continues to roll towards us, with the global gathering taking place in Auckland, New Zealand this November. The latest information regarding the programme and keynote speakers are available on the conference website.

The global gathering in 2026 will be in Hiroshima, Japan and **the UK are going to put in a bid for 2027**. Please join the mailing list, or contact us directly or through our social media accounts, if you'd like to be involved in the bid.

Additionally, FOSS4G-ASIA 2026 is to be held between 21-25 January 2026 in Nashik, India. The event organisers remain on the lookout for sponsors. The local organising committee are putting together a great looking event but all help is appreciated. Find out more and contact the organising team through their [website](#).

And just to remind you that our friends over at the AGI (Association for Geographic Information) have a Foresight conference coming up in November (see [details here](#)). If you attend this then please let us know - or even provide a short write-up for this newsletter!

We hope that you found this edition of the newsletter interesting and informative. If you have any feedback or comments then let us know!

You can check out the [April](#) and [June](#) 2025 newsletters and feel free to share this and previous newsletters with your colleagues and friends.

If you would like to unsubscribe, please [click here](#).

